ASHWINI CHAUDHARY

CTO | Hands-on Engineer | Product, Platform & Agent Systems

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PROFILE

Hands-on CTO with 13+ years across backend systems, payments, platform engineering, reliability, and security. I'm still deeply involved in building the Diversio and Optimo products, improving them across the backend, infrastructure, security, performance, and cost. Alongside that I've built the agents and tooling the whole company now works with: an engineering agent on Pi Durable, an automated PR reviewer, Pi extensions, worktree-based dev environments, and local CI. I tend to pick up whatever is slowing a team down, whether or not it's my area, and ship a fix.

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer

Diversio Inc

Jul 2024 – Present Toronto

- Lead Diversio's pivot to Optimo and own engineering end to end, from architecture and technical strategy to shipping features in both products myself.
- Built little-person, our automated PR reviewer: a Temporal-backed worker that reviews against our own standards and only spends a deep review on PRs that are ready, which keeps token spend low. It has reviewed 1,100+ PRs and took human review out of the critical path for the team.
- Built Courage, the engineering agent the whole company now uses in Slack and GitHub, on Pi Durable. It investigates issues, opens PRs, does a lighter automatic review on every PR alongside little-person, triages Sentry and infra alerts, runs sandboxes, and posts deploy and cost feeds, routing each request to a quick, standard, or deep model tier, behind host guards that block merges and secret leaks.
- Built Dev Center (Rust), which gives every worktree its own services, database, and URLs and hands its state to Claude, Codex, or Pi, and local-ci-runner (Go, open source), which runs checks locally and posts GitHub statuses only for verified snapshots.
- Wrote Pi extensions (pi-monitor, ci-status, image-router, pi-cmux) and 23 Claude Code/Codex plugins in a public marketplace the whole team uses.
- Cut the AWS bill by about a third over the past year while keeping production in SOC 2 scope, and moved CI, preview environments, and internal tools in-house where that was cheaper and fit us better.
- Part of Diversio's first SOC 2; now run this year's audit largely on my own across engineering, infrastructure, and admin, with most checks and evidence automated.
- Migrated most of the company's older manual processes onto Courage and cloud agents, and moved every credential and API key off people's laptops into 1Password and managed secrets.
- Led vendor rationalization and a successful SR&ED round; migrated our API workflow from Postman to Bruno (the post was later featured in Bruno's marketing).
- Hired and mentored engineers and co-op students from the University of Toronto, Queen's, Waterloo, and other top programs.

LEADERSHIP FOCUS

- Agent harnesses, tools, and guardrails
- Developer tooling and local-first workflows
- Backend, platform, and infrastructure
- Reliability, security, and compliance
- Hiring, mentoring, and code quality

CORE STACK

TypeScript, Python, Go, Rust, Django, Postgres, AWS, Terraform, Docker, Redis, Pi, Claude Code, Codex, MCP, Linux, and Git.

RECENT BUILDS

Courage
Engineering agent on Pi Durable. Conversations move between Slack and the CLI (Claude Code, Pi).

little-person
Automated PR reviewer on Temporal. 1,100+ PRs reviewed.

Pi extensions
pi-monitor, ci-status, image-router, pi-cmux.

Dev Center & local-ci
Worktree dev environments (Rust) and local CI (Go).

Cineplex Seat Watcher
Alerts for specific seats and new showtimes. Live.

RECOGNITION

- Stack Overflow: 252K reputation, 3,700+ answers, ranked #287 overall.
- Unsplash: 218M+ views, 1.3M+ downloads, and top 1000 on the platform.
- Arctic Code Vault Contributor.
- Won Instamojo's hackathon for building a payments-powered vending machine.

WRITING

- Claude Code features you may not have tried yet
- All tools should now have two users
- How we use AI like engineers

Head of Engineering

Diversio Inc

Jul 2023 – Jun 2024 Toronto

- Led engineering execution through hiring, mentoring, delivery improvements, internal tooling, and engineering standards.
- Directed platform and stack consolidation after Diversio's acquisition of CCDI Consulting Inc.

Lead Engineer

Diversio Inc

Aug 2019 – Jun 2023 Toronto / Remote

- Early engineering hire who helped build core backend systems and infrastructure across multiple products.
- Owned infrastructure (Terraform, Terragrunt), deployments, and production operations.
- Led Diversio's first SOC 2 and multiple penetration testing rounds and their remediation.

Software Engineer

Unhaggle Inc

Nov 2017 – Feb 2021 Remote

- Owned infrastructure, site reliability, and deployments for the Dealer team.
- Built internal tools and delivered performance improvements in Python and PostgreSQL.

Senior Software Engineer

Instamojo

Mar 2015 – Oct 2017 Bengaluru

- Led backend work on card processing and storage projects.
- Built Instamojo's e-commerce plugins and SDKs across WordPress, Magento, Drupal, and others, plus Python, Ruby, and PHP wrappers.
- Delivered KYC onboarding, the Orders API, gateway integrations, and automated refunds, and helped port the main application from Python 2 to 3.

Python Developer

Simform Solutions

Sep 2013 – Feb 2015 Ahmedabad

- Built the real-time backend for SentMap using Node.js, Socket.IO, and Express to stream market and sentiment data over WebSockets.
- Built Django REST API backends and Twisted-based group chat for two mobile apps.
- No code by hand
- Protecting our own tenant in a multi-tenant SaaS

OPEN SOURCE

- Contributed to typeshed, mypy, django-debug-toolbar, pep8speaks, pgmpy, and others.
- Public tools: auto-uv-env, microverse, wt, ew, pi-cmux, clickup-mcp, local-ci-runner, and the Diversio agent skills marketplace.
- Spoke at MUPy and coached at Django Girls Bangalore.

EDUCATION

B.Tech. in IT

IMS Engineering College

2009 – 2013 Ghaziabad

LINKS

ashwch.com

github.com/ashwch

linkedin.com/in/ashwch

Stack Overflow

Unsplash